

Vivo X200 FE

A flagship energy that pushes limits to the max

At a time when flagship phones are pushing both physical and financial limits, the Vivo X200 FE feels like a defiant little rebel. A Rs 54,999 phone that doesn't need to scream for attention with curved displays or a trillion-megapixel main camera. Instead, it walks in quietly, dressed in a neat 6.3-inch frame, packed to the gills with ZEISS optics, a 6500 mAh battery, and the new Dimensity 9300+ chip.

Vivo's pitching this not just as another compact Android, but as a phone you could genuinely get work done on, shoot actual content with, and maybe leave your DSLR at home for. It even promises studio-like portraits and ridiculously sharp 10x zoom captures. That's a bold claim, especially when "FE" editions often stand for "feature-enough" rather than "fully equipped."

So naturally, we had to test it. And after a week of using it as my primary phone for emails, edits, camera testing, doomscrolling, and watching videos, I'm convinced this phone is more than just a compact flagship. It might just be one of the most unexpectedly complete packages Vivo has made in years.

DESIGN & BUILD

The Vivo X200 FE stands out for one key reason: it's compact without feeling compromised. At 6.31 inches and weighing around 188 grams, this is one of the few premium smartphones that can be comfortably used with one hand. That alone makes it worth considering if you're tired of phones that feel bulky in everyday use, especially when navigating with one hand or using it on the go.

Vivo has opted for a flat frame made of aerospace-grade aluminium, which contributes to both structural strength and a reassuring in-hand feel. The design is simple, clean, and



deliberate. The phone's rear panel uses a textured glass finish called Metallic Sand AG, which improves grip, resists fingerprints, and gives the surface a soft, almost frosted touch. Unlike glossy finishes that attract smudges easily, this one stays clean longer and feels premium under your fingers.

The back panel slightly curves into the side frame, and the camera module, while raised, is integrated with a dual-layer aluminium ring system. This avoids wobble on flat surfaces and gives a visually balanced look. The design is clearly functional, not ornamental, and that restraint works in its favour.

Durability is another strong point. The X200 FE is IP68 and IP69 certified, which means it's not just splash-resistant, it's also fully protected against dust and can handle high-pressure water jets. This level of water and dust protection is still really rare at this price

point and adds genuine peace of mind. The SCHOTT Xensation glass on the front further improves drop resistance, especially for those pesky everyday knocks and edge impacts.

The phone is available in three colours: Frost Blue, Amber Yellow, and Luxe Black. Each has a matte texture and subdued finish, with Frost Blue offering a cooler aesthetic, Luxe Black looking professional, and Amber Yellow leaning more expressive. The overall build quality feels solid, there's no flex or creak, and all the buttons are tactile and well-placed.

If you're someone who values practicality, pocketability, and understated design over just sheer screen size or flashy aesthetics, the Vivo X200 FE delivers exactly that. It's a phone that is built to last and easy to live with, and that alone sets it apart from a lot of other "flagship-lite" options in the market.

PERFORMANCE

The Vivo X200 FE is powered by the MediaTek Dimensity 9300+, which is a flagship-grade chip with all-big-core architecture. This means that instead of using a mix of efficiency and performance cores, there are 8 high-performance cores which prioritise raw power over theoretical power savings.

In daily use, the phone is fast, fluid, and consistent. Apps open instantly, transitions are smooth, and even under pressure, the system stays responsive.

When we look at synthetic benchmarks, the X200 FE performs well:

- **AnTuTu:** 1,802,418
- **Geekbench 6:** 2198 (Single-Core), 7180 (Multi-Core)
- **PCMark Work 3.0:** 16,520
- **3DMark WildLife Extreme:** 4138

What stands out here is not just the peak performance, but the sustained output. In the CPU Throttling Test, the phone retained 95% of its peak performance, and even after prolonged stress, there was no thermal throttling. The